



small caps. With Nifty 50 dominating market capitalisation, a diversified approach is essential.

Those seeking a cautious approach can consider multi-asset allocation funds for diversification. Additionally, with recent tax relief on ₹12 lakh income, there will be a huge universe for conservative hybrid funds, which invest up to 25% in equities and the rest in high-quality debt.



***What will be the biggest trend***

***in the mutual fund industry going forward?***

The mutual fund industry has gained positive momentum over the past decade. Awareness and acceptance of mutual funds as a reliable investment option have grown significantly, reinforcing the belief that “mutual funds are right.” However, the next step is even more critical for determining what is right for each individual investor.

Investment needs vary from person to person. What may be

suitable for one investor might not be the best for another. This makes personalisation and investor-centric advisory key focus areas.

The challenge lies in going deeper, understanding individual financial goals, and ensuring that investors are guided toward products that truly align with their needs.



***Do you think the ₹250-rupee SIP initiative by the Securities and Exchange Board of India***

PHOTO BY **MILIND SHELTE**



**DESPITE DAILY FLUCTUATIONS, MIDCAPS CONTINUE TO OUTPERFORM, INDICATING SELECT OPPORTUNITIES STILL EXIST FOR INVESTORS FOCUSING ON A QUALITY PORTFOLIO**

| 77

***will be viable for the mutual fund industry?***

The ₹250 SIP initiative is a step towards financial inclusion. While some fund houses have raised concerns about covering costs, this is not a major issue. Costs can be managed, and fund houses have the flexibility to cross-subsidise. A significant portion of the population, particularly at the lower end of the economic pyramid, is yet to participate in the equity market. As they begin investing, India's large population and democratic framework can become a strength. **BT**

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